



Department of Telecommunications
Telecommunication Engineering Centre
K. L. Bhawan, Janpath, New Delhi – 110001
(Convergence & Broadcasting Division)



No: 4-16/2018-C&B/TEC/NWG-9

Dated: 8th of March 2024

Sub: Minutes of the 13th Meeting of National Working Group-9 (NWG-9) regarding "Broadband Cable and TV", held on 23.02.2024.

The 13th meeting of the National Working Group-9 (NWG-9) corresponding to the ITU-T Study Group 9 (SG9), regarding "Audiovisual content transmission and integrated broadband cable networks/ Broadband Cable and TV", was held on 23.02.2024 under the chairmanship of Sh. Avinash Agarwal, DDG (Convergence & Broadcasting) TEC, through video-conferencing. List of participants is placed at **Annexure-I**.

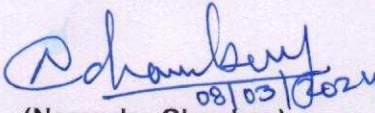
2. Sh. Narendra Choubey, Convener NWG-9 & Director (C&B) TEC, welcomed all the participants and provided a summary of the previous meeting held on 20.10.2023.
3. Sh. Avinash Agarwal, Chairman NWG-9 & DDG (C&B) TEC, in his opening remarks, conveyed that the 3rd ITU-T SG9 meeting for the study period 2022-2024 was held in Bogota (Colombia) from 14-23 Nov 2023. Based on the recommendation of NWG-9 (in its 12th meeting), eight (8) contributions were submitted and presented from India in this meeting. In addition, an ITU Workshop on "The Future of Television for the Americas", was also organized by ITU-T on 17.11.2023 during this SG-9 meeting. The workshop provided an opportunity to discuss TV-related regional and international standardization and to share best practices and case studies on TV implementations over various media as well as new TV services. In this workshop, Sh. Avinash Agarwal, DDG(C&B), TEC participated as a speaker and gave a presentation on the topic "Perspectives from India" in the Session 1 (Shaping the Future of Television - Market Trends, Business Models, and Policy Catalysts).
4. Sh. Avinash Agarwal, Chairman NWG-9 & DDG (C&B) TEC presented the executive summary of ITU-T meeting held in Bogota, 14-23 November, 2023.
5. The following were discussed and deliberated in the meeting:-

S.N.	Work Items/Topics	Deliberation
1.	Merger of SG-9 and SG-16 ITU-T Study Groups	➤ Shri Avinash Agarwal initiated discussions on the proposed merger. ➤ Prof. Pradipta Biswas highlighted that the decision originated from the TSAG meetings, held in February 2024. ➤ Concerns were raised about the compatibility of the merger due to distinct work items and broader perspectives of SG-9 and SG-16. ➤ Emphasis was placed on SG16's broader perspective on multimedia, SG9's focus on cable TV, and the emerging areas like metaverse, haptics, requiring a dedicated study group.
2.	APT Meeting Updates:	➤ DDG (C & B) briefed about the last APT meeting held on 5th and 6th February 2024 and thirty (30)

		contributions submitted, including three resolutions related to SG 9. ➤ He briefed about Resolution 70 (Telecommunication/information and communication technology accessibility for persons with disabilities and persons with specific needs), new proposed resolution on responsible artificial intelligence, and modifications to resolution 2 on the scope of Study Groups. ➤ He also informed about the upcoming third APT region meeting scheduled for 30th April to 2nd May, 2024 to discuss and deliberate on these contributions.
3.	New Proposal on Responsible AI Resolution	➤ DDG (C & B) emphasized the importance of deploying AI responsibly, addressing challenges such as biases. ➤ Proposed resolution to focus on principles like fairness, robustness, scalability, security, accountability, and sustainability while deploying AI in telecom networks & services.
4.	Q 11/9 Proposal for updating the baseline text of the Draft new Technical Report ITU-T JSTR.LCAP "Technical advances, challenges, and best practices in live captioning"	➤ DDG (C & B) suggested expanding the scope of Q11/9 beyond physical disabilities to include situational impairments, considerations for the elderly, language barriers, and emerging technologies. ➤ Further suggested to expand the scope by including emerging technologies such as AI, augmented reality, virtual reality, extended reality, and metaverse.
5.	Q6/9 on ITU-T Recommendation J.STB-UHDVR "Functional requirements for cable Set-top Box supporting Ultra-High- Definition video and Virtual Reality services."	➤ DDG (C&B) informed about the framing of a standard by TEC for Hybrid Set Top Box that supports Ultra-High-Definition video and Virtual Reality services. The DDG (C&B) thanked all members for providing valuable input on the preparation of the standard.
6.	Discussion on Upcoming Contributions:	➤ DDG (C&B) requested to all members to examine the contributions on Q1/9 (Wifi TV), Q2/9 (DRM), Q6/9 (UHDVR), Q11/9, TR.CUP, JSTR.LCAP, IRG-AVA, etc. for detailed discussions in upcoming meetings. ➤ Discussions on LCAP, including input from BBC and SG 6, were shared and further discussions are planned for future meetings. ➤ Sh. Shubhanshu Gupta, CDAC, Sh. Rajeev Khattar and Sh. Paritosh Saha shared views on the documents referred by ITU-R SG6 for this work item and agreed to discuss them in future meetings.
7.	New Work Items:	➤ DDG (C & B) emphasized on finding new work items for future contributions to ITU-T SG-9.

8.	Meeting Frequency and Notices:	➤ Shri Rajeev Khattar requested more frequent meetings, suggesting fixed monthly meeting dates. ➤ Members proposed including a calendar in meeting notices for automatic reminders.
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6. All NWG members were again requested to examine the current profile/responsibilities of SG9 and terms of references of the various Questions and identify areas/topics that required to be updated.
7. Meeting end with Vote of Thanks to all.


 08/03/2024
 (Narendra Choubey)

Convener, NWG-9 & Director, (C&B), TEC

Encl.: Annexure-I

To,

All members of the NWG-9 and all the Participants.

Copy for kind information to:

1. Sr. DDG TEC, New Delhi
2. Chairman NWG-9 & DDG (C&B), TEC, New Delhi.

ANNEXURE-I

List of Participants:

1. Sh. Avinash Agarwal, Chairman NWG-9 & DDG (C&B), TEC
2. Prof. Pradipta Biswas, Vice-chair NWG-9 & IISc
3. Sh. Shubhanshu Gupta, C-DAC
4. Sh. Rajiv Khattar, Researcher & Industry specialist
5. Sh. Paritosh Saha, Disney-Hotstar
6. Sh. Neetesh Kumar Meena, JTO, TEC
7. Sh. Narendra Choubey, Convener, NWG-9 & Director (C &B), TEC
8. Sh. Satbir Singh, Under Secretary
9. Sh. Harsh Sharma, NWG-9 & Director (Standardization), TEC